question of principle but at the same time present a workable agreement. His anxiety was, as it was the anxiety of many of us, that in matters like this we should proceed with the greatest measure of agreement. He referred to the pledge which the Congress party gave for the abolition of zamindari. As he rightly pointed out the declaration was that zamindari would be abolished, for which fair compensation would be paid. Whether right or wrong, there are many parties which say that no compensation should be given and others who insist that the fullest compensation should be given. In any case the Congress stood for abolition of zamindari on payment of fair compensation.

An Hon. Member: Equitable compensation.

Dr S.P. Mookerjee: Equitable compensation. That was the pledge which was given by the Congress. Now, when you passed the Constitution after a good deal of discussion, what is the framework that you produced? We were anxious that the quantum of compensation should not at every stage, be subject to judicial decisions. At the same time, we were anxious that a certain framework should be placed before the country and the persons concerned so that the fullest measure of assurance could be given to all concerned. Now, Article 31 provides that either the actual compensation or the principles on which compensation is to be paid, or the principles on which payment is to be made, will all be determined by law. We also protected certain specific legislative measures which were passed eighteen months prior to the commencement of the Constitution.

That is how matters stand now. What has happened since then? That there has been delay is not the fault of the Constitution. There is only one party which is ruling India today. All the Governments are under the control of a centrally organized party. It is not that one particular party in one particular State proceeds in one manner and another party in another State proceeds in another manner. Why has not the Centre set down and given some sort of a formula saying: ‘This is the formula which every State should adopt in effecting land reforms, making such minor changes as local conditions may